

LinkedIn Post Templates — Hack to the Future

FOR BUILDERS WHO WANT TO POST BUT DON'T KNOW WHERE TO START.

How to use these

Eight templates. Pick the one that fits your style — don't force-fit your story into a template. Replace every [bracketed bit] with something specific to *your* build.

The thing that makes these work isn't the template structure — it's the **specificity** of what you fill in. Vague fills produce vague posts.

- "I built an AI tool" → bad fill.
- "I built a vernacular FD advisor that responds in Hindi to users who've never used a financial app before" → good fill.

LinkedIn posts work best at **120-220 words**. Anything longer gets a "see more" cut, which kills engagement. Most templates here are tuned to that range.

Tag @Blostem and use #HackToTheFuture so we can re-share from the official handle.

Post when you have something honest to say. If you're not feeling it, skip — performative posts are obvious, and there's no rubric points for posting.

1. The "Building Toward Demo Day" Post

When: Friday or Saturday morning, before your demo. **Vibe:** Anticipation + honest nerves. Works because it's pre-result, so the post is about the journey, not the outcome.

4 weeks ago, @Blostem assigned me a hard problem: [one-line problem statement].

I had no idea where to start.

Tomorrow morning, I'm demoing what I built at Blostem HQ in Noida.

What I built: [one-sentence product description].

The bet I made: [the one technical or product decision that shaped everything].

What I'm most nervous about: [one honest concern — "the demo doesn't crash" is fine].

Update incoming Saturday evening.

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Why this works: The “I had no idea where to start” line lands harder than people expect. It’s honest, relatable, and signals growth — which is what most readers actually engage with.

2. The Build-Log Post

When: Friday or Saturday morning. Good if you want a structured story. **Vibe:** A four-week journey, in five lines. Shows the arc.

```
Last 4 weeks at the @Blostem hackathon, in 5 lines.
```

```
Week 1: [what you understood about the problem – usually a surprise about the user]
```

```
Week 2: [the first version you built – what worked, what didn't]
```

```
Week 3: [what broke + what you tried]
```

```
Week 4: [the version you're shipping + why you're shipping it]
```

```
Demoing at Blostem HQ tomorrow. Walkthrough video coming Saturday night.
```

```
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```

Why this works: Each week is one line. Resist the urge to write paragraphs — the constraint is the post.

3. The Demo-Day Recap Post

When: Saturday afternoon or evening, after your demo. **Vibe:** Energetic, specific, slightly tired. The “I shipped” post.

Just demoed at @Blostem HQ.

The challenge: [one-line problem statement].

What I shipped: [one-line solution + the concrete user outcome it produces].

Tech stack: [3-4 things – model, framework, data layer, deployment if any].

Hardest judge question: "[paraphrased question]"

My answer: [your answer in 1-2 lines – yes, even if you fumbled].

What I'd build next with another month: [one specific feature or fix].

Live: [link, if any]

Code: [GitHub link]

Thanks to my mentor [name] for the unblock on [specific thing], and to the @Blostem team for putting this together.

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Why this works: Including the hardest judge question — even if you fumbled it — signals confidence. Hiding it signals the opposite.

4. The Technical-Decision Post

When: Anytime — pre, during, or post. For builders who want a thoughtful, engineering-flavoured angle. **Vibe:** Senior. The kind of post other engineers comment on.

Building [your product] for the @Blostem hackathon, I had to make one call early that shaped everything: [the technical decision – RAG vs fine-tune, on-device vs cloud, monolith vs services, sync vs async, etc.].

Why I picked [your choice]:

1. [reason 1 – usually about constraints – cost, latency, compliance]
2. [reason 2 – usually about user experience]
3. [reason 3 – usually about what could go wrong]

The tradeoff I accepted: [the honest downside].

Was it the right call? [Yes / partially / I'd revisit X]. With another sprint, I'd change: [one specific thing].

Demoed at Blostem HQ today. [Live link, if any]

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Why this works: Engineers respect builders who can name a tradeoff out loud. This post tends to attract good comment threads.

5. The “What Broke and What Shipped” Post

When: Saturday evening or Sunday. For builders who want to be honest about the messy parts.

Vibe: Unfiltered. The post that reads like a journal entry.

4 weeks. 1 working product. Here's what broke along the way.

Building [your product] for the @Blostem hackathon – the unfiltered version:

Day 3: [first thing that broke + how you fixed it]

Day 12: [second blocker + the workaround]

Day 21: [the redesign moment – when you realised the original plan was wrong]

Day 28: [the thing that's still imperfect – and why I'm shipping it anyway]

Imperfect and shipped beats perfect and post-hoc.

Live: [link, if any]

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Why this works: The dates make it specific and believable. “Imperfect and shipped beats perfect and post-hoc” is the program’s anchor line — borrow it.

6. The “Three Things I Learned” Post

When: Sunday or Monday after demo day. The reflection post. **Vibe:** Calm, thoughtful. Reads well a day later when the dust has settled.

```
3 things I learned at the @Blostem hackathon – beyond writing code:
```

1. [insight about the user – usually something that surprised you]
2. [insight about the technology you used]
3. [insight about yourself as a builder]

```
Walked in 4 weeks ago thinking [original assumption].  
Walked out thinking [updated belief].
```

```
Built [one-line description of what you built]. Live: [link].
```

```
Thanks to my mentor [name] and the @Blostem team for the push.
```

```
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```

Why this works: The “walked in thinking X, walked out thinking Y” structure is a quiet flex — it shows you updated your beliefs, which is the rarest signal on LinkedIn.

7. The “Hardest Judge Question” Post

When: Saturday night or Sunday. For builders whose Q&A taught them something. **Vibe:** Story-shaped. Single moment, told well.

```
The hardest question a judge asked at the @Blostem hackathon today:
```

```
"[paraphrased question – keep it short]"
```

```
I paused. Then I said: [your actual answer in 2–3 lines, even if it was imperfect].
```

```
What I learned from that one question: [insight about your project, your approach,  
or yourself].
```

```
Built [one-line product description]. [Link, if any].
```

```
The questions teach you more than the building does.
```

```
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```

Why this works: Storytelling beats listing. One moment, one insight — easier to read than a feature dump.

8. The Gratitude / Acknowledgement Post

When: Sunday morning. The post that warms the cohort. **Vibe:** Warm, public, specific.

Spent yesterday at @Blostem HQ demoing [your product] — built over 4 weeks for the Hack to the Future hackathon.

Three people I want to thank publicly:

- [Mentor name], who unblocked me on [specific thing] when I was stuck for two days.
- [Cohort builder name], for the accidentally-genius suggestion about [something].
- The @Blostem team, for running the program with this much care.

Most useful feedback I got: [one piece of judge feedback you're going to act on].

Live: [link]. Code: [GitHub link].

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Why this works: Specific gratitude reads as authentic; generic gratitude reads as performative. Naming people + naming what they helped with is the difference.

Things to NOT do

A few patterns we'd ask you to avoid — they read as forced and tend to get awkward engagement.

- **Don't post if you didn't ship.** "I tried but couldn't finish in time" posts feel like apologies. Skip the post. Build for next time.
- **Don't post AI-generated copy.** Everyone can tell. The em-dashes give it away. (Yes, even when an em-dash is grammatically correct.)
- **Don't post a stock photo of "AI" or "fintech."** Use a screenshot of *your* product, or no image at all.
- **Don't tag every Blostem person individually.** Tag @Blostem once.
- **Don't claim you're the first to do something** unless you've actually checked. Builders see through it.
- **Don't make the post about the hackathon brand.** Make it about *what you built and what you learned*. The brand mention is incidental, not the point.

A note on engagement

Posts that ask a real question at the end get better engagement than posts that don't. If your project pushed against an interesting tradeoff or a real user problem, end with something like:

"If you've built something similar — how did you handle [specific problem]? Curious to hear."

Don't force this if there's no real question. Forced curiosity is also obvious.

A note on timing

Saturday evening (8-10 PM IST) is the highest-engagement window for this kind of audience. Sunday morning (9-11 AM IST) is the second-best. If you can post during one of those windows, do — but don't lose sleep over it. The post matters more than the timing.

That's it. Pick one, fill it with something specific, post it. We'll re-share the strong ones from the @Blostem handle.